

Kenstar Maha Kool HC 90

Do traditional air coolers make sense in the age of ACs?

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Delhi is finally starting to warm up, and I don't say this in a happy mood.

Currently, in early April, the temperature is around 32°C, and ceiling fans have begun to fall short. At the same time, switching on an AC for long hours still feels excessive. In my case, we use air coolers at our home. My relation with air coolers goes back a long way to my childhood and a time when we didn't have ACs. I'm sure many of you can also relate to this. While the old school coolers were big chunky metal boxes placed outside the windows, taking up a lot of space in our balconies sometimes, the new ones are lighter and more portable. They come in different sizes, shapes and colours to match our indoor space and ambience.

I already have a 90L and a 43L cooler for two of our rooms. And I recently got this Kenstar Maha Kool HC 90 desert cooler from the brand, which, is also a 90L cooler. I used it in two rooms, sized about 14×10 ft and 18×12 ft, for several days and nights. So, in case you are wondering if it makes sense to buy a room cooler this big this summer, let me take you through my experience.

Design and first-time setup

The Kenstar Maha Kool HC 90 is a big 90L cooler. But at 24kg (without water inside) it is not too heavy. I unpacked it with my brother's help. The side panels with the honeycomb filter came in



pre-installed. I only had to screw in its trolley stand. Simply move it around and plug it in. The four sturdy wheels at the bottom make it very portable.

Filling the 90-litre tank took about 7 minutes using a continuous water source. Well, based on the force of the water, this could change a bit. There is a long, roughly 10-inch translucent water level indicator on the front of the tank area. It is legible, and you also get an 'Overflow' sticker as a marking to avoid overfilling in a hurry.

Another minor qualm is with how tightly the refill inlet and side panels are fitted. This small tray in front of the cooler is tough to pull out. Similarly, when I tried pulling out the back panel, it was also very tight.

Cooling experience

Since it isn't that hot in Delhi now, I was using the Kenstar Maha Kool HC 90 at its lowest settings. But that gives an idea of the bare minimum experience we can expect. So, I ran it in Cool-Swing settings and sometimes Cool with the speed at low mode. Sometimes, for testing, I had it on simple Swing and also ran it on higher speeds.

Regardless of the speed, cooling starts quickly. It does its job of cooling the air in the room within a few minutes. You feel it more if you are sitting adjacent to the cooler and facing the direct airflow. I am used to speed as I already have a 90L model from a competing brand. But this one's size is bigger, and the performance is slightly better. My brother, who has the smaller 43L cooler, noticed the difference the first time we switched it on.

Kenstar has equipped this biggie with its proprietary ProForce cooling technology. That, with the double-bearing motor and the 18-inch fan, claims a 50ft throw. That's peak figure, possibly achievable in lab conditions, and in a real-world closed room, at about 15 ft, you feel the force of the air. If you move further, around 20ft, you'll need to turn on the Medium mode, and past that, you'll need the High mode. The max, I could feel the cool air up to 22ft.

The higher speeds feel aggressive for this temperature. But, I am sure, they will come in handy soon.

You can adjust the direction of the wind to some extent using the vertical and horizontal louvres (the flaps). The horizontal louvres have two halves. The one facing the user is fixed, and its other interior half is movable. This design choice may be for the flap's durability, but it may bounce off some of the air. With the cooler's big opening on the front, the airflow should be plenty. **A**

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